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1. Travel through the English countryside and back in time on the restored 1920s carriages of Belmond's British Pullman

2. For a taste of South-East Asia, visit Chiva Som in Hua Hin, Thailand's iconic wellness resort

3. Board the Antara Luxury River Cruises to journey along the Ganga from September to May

4. Go skiing in Niseko in Japan's northern island of Hokkaido, instead of the Swiss Alps

5. Situated in between a crater and a volcano is The Highlands in the Ngorongoro Conservation Area of Tanzania



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RIVER CRUISES

Unlike ocean cruise liners that are like mini cities, river cruises are smaller and more intimate. Rivers across the globe from the Nile to the Mekong offer cruises. But here's one that's the ultimate in luxury. Belmond has launched a new luxury barge—part of its French collection—called Coquelicot that will take guests on a personalised journey of Champagne as it travels through its canals. Coquelicot will debut in May 2023 and has partnered with Maison Ruinart, the world's oldest Champagne house. On offer: a weeklong private charter starting at €82,000 (approximately \$79,500). Closer home, board the Antara

Luxury River Cruises to journey along the Ganga from September to May. The routes include Varanasi to Patna to Kolkata to Dibrugarh to Guwahati and to Dhaka. The boat has 28 suites and an eight-day trip costs approximately \$2,958 per person.

NEW DESTINATIONS

While there is a sense of comfort and familiarity in going back for a vacation to your favourite destination, there is so much more to see and experience in the world that it's good to get out of your comfort zone every now and then. As per Booking.com, 63 per cent of Indians wish to explore lesser-known cities with hidden gems

that aren't already on the radar. Go skiing in Niseko in Japan's northern island of Hokkaido, instead of the Alps. Visit Italy beyond the obvious—check out places such as Bolzano, where several cultures collide, or the Trentino Alto Adige region with the majestic Dolomite mountains. Prague without doubt is one of the prettiest cities of Europe, so much so that even Hitler didn't want to destroy it. But explore Olomouc, one of the top destinations in the Czech Republic to visit for architecture. It has several monuments that date back to the Roman times and is home to two World Heritage Sites. **BT**

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